

Aaron Scherf

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Over 7 years of experience implementing international development, foreign policy, data analytics, and applied empirical research. Led monitoring and evaluation for multi-billion dollar portfolios in Ukraine and Colombia, including cross-cutting design, budgeting, and stakeholder communication. Technical specializations in statistical analysis, geospatial technology, data visualization, and impact evaluation.

WORK EXPERIENCE

U.S. Agency for International Development

05/2019 – 07/2025

Foreign Service Officer – Monitoring, Evaluation, Learning Team Lead (FS 3–5)

Kyiv, Ukraine

- Supervised \$36M contract for monitoring, evaluation, and learning services, including developing new systems for performance tracking, strategy alignment, and context research.
- Supervised implementation of 20 program evaluations, including leading design of a \$1.5M randomized control trial to evaluate impact of \$450M credit facilitation program for small businesses.
- Co-created third-party monitoring system which conducted over 3,000 verification visits in a year.
- Led collection of annual performance metrics and sectoral narratives for 52 development programs, aligning inter-agency indicator framework with new countrywide strategy and scorecard.
- Developed analytics system to track \$5Bn in electrical infrastructure support by administrative geography, enabling rapid repairs in response to Russian missile strikes and increased accountability.

Foreign Service Officer – MEL and Program Design Officer (FS 4–9)

Bogota, Colombia

- Led the design process for four new programs in smallholder agriculture, environmental conservation, and rural land titling, including developing indicators to measure job-expanding policy reforms.
- Developed data system to process and classify high-resolution drone imagery, resulting in over 600 new land titles issued to smallholder farmers in flood-prone areas in first 6 months.
- Led collection of over 500 performance indicators across 32 development programs for annual report.

Foreign Service Officer – Program Officer (FS 5–12)

Washington, DC, USA

- Supported annual performance review and budgeting processes for Honduras office, revising dozens of key issue narratives and performance indicator justifications.
- Won annual agency-wide award for developing budget data processing and visualization tool using Python and Tableau, saving hundreds of hours of staff time in negotiations with State Department.

Monitoring and Evaluation Specialist (Visiting Fellow)

Pretoria, South Africa

- Revised evaluation methodology for 12 regional programs to improve validity of performance metrics.
- Supported real-time data analytics for PEPFAR programs focused on HIV/AIDS epidemic in 7 countries.

Centre for European Economic Research (ZEW)

11/2017 – 07/2018

Graduate Research Fellow – Migration and Labor Economics

Mannheim, Germany

- Conducted statistical analysis of asylum seekers' education level and living conditions relation to employment outcomes using advanced econometric methods in Stata and data calls in SQL.
- Co-authored research paper in German on policy reform for refugee job placement in Rhine-Neckar region. Presented in German to city councils in Heidelberg and Mannheim.

U.S. House of Representatives

05/2017 – 08/2017

Policy Analyst – Congressman Crowley and House Democratic Caucus

Washington, DC, USA

- Created financial model to analyze differential impacts by age bracket of proposed retirement savings bill, to prepare Democratic Caucus members for debate.
- Wrote 6 briefings on policy issues for review by the representative, discussing new sanctions on Russia and the Technology Modernization Fund.

EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology

Master of Science in Computer Science • GPA: 3.88

Atlanta, GA, USA • 01/2022 – 08/2026

Specialization in machine learning, artificial intelligence, and AI ethics

Indiana State University

Master of Science in Mathematics • GPA: 3.85

Terre Haute, IN, USA • 05/2021 – 05/2024

Thesis: Novel Omnibus Normality Test and Power Comparison with the Shapiro-Wilk

University of California, Berkeley

Master of Science in Development Practice • GPA: 3.94

Berkeley, CA, USA • 07/2018 – 05/2020

Thesis: Predicting the Yield of CIMMYT Wheat Genotypes via Remote Sensing and Machine Learning

Mercer University

Bachelor in International Finance and Economics • GPA: 3.91

Macon, GA, USA • 08/2013 – 05/2017

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Donald M. Payne International Development Fellow (\$100,000 graduate fellowship)	05/2017
Humanity in Action Senior Fellow (in partnership with Amnesty International)	05/2017
Fulbright Scholar (Graduate Research Fellow in Heidelberg, DE)	05/2017
Stamps Foundation Leadership Scholar (\$240,000 undergraduate scholarship)	05/2013

RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS & PUBLICATIONS

Autonomous Drone Deployment Grid for Improved Wildfire Response in California	05/2020
UC Berkeley: Innovations in Disaster Response Showcase	
Applications of PCA for Mapping Regional Socioeconomic Vulnerability Indices	12/2019
UC Berkeley: Data for Human Mobility Lab	
Integration Progress: Results from two Reallabor Surveys of Asylum Seekers	08/2018
Centre for European Economic Research (ZEW)	
Published at: https://www.econstor.eu/handle/10419/231442	
“OurBlock” – Blockchain Based Property Registry for South African Land Reform	03/2017
Harvard Social Entrepreneurship Pitch Competition	
“How to Kill a Microfinance Fund” – Analysis of Microcredit Policy in South Africa	10/2016
Southern Conference Undergraduate Research Forum	
“Peer2Peer” – Digital Marketplace for Asset-Collateralized Microcredit Exchange	06/2016
Thomson Reuters’ “Land Rights in Africa” Hackathon and Pitch Contest	

SKILLS

Computer Programming

- Python, R, JavaScript
- Stata, MatLab, Excel
- SQL, Azure, GCP
- Agentic AI (CrewAI / AutoGen)
- Artificial Neural Networks
- Machine Learning
- Large Language Models
- Tableau and PowerBI
- Data Collection & Processing

Applied Economic Research

- GIS Analysis (ArcGIS / GEE)
- Applied Econometrics
- Environmental Analysis
- Empirical Policy Analysis
- Development Economics
- Causal Impact Evaluation
- Survey Design / Distribution
- Statistical Modeling
- Data Visualization

Languages and Other

- Spanish – Professional
- German – Intermediate
- Ukrainian – Elementary
- Contract Management
- Budget Management
- Report and Memo Writing
- Stakeholder Engagement
- Presentations and Training
- Top Secret Clearance